

✓ Empty-Shelf Detector — Week 1

Fine-tune YOLO11 to flag out-of-stocks on retail shelf photos.

✓ 0. Turn the GPU on first

Colab gives you a free GPU but **not by default**. Do this once:

Runtime → Change runtime type → Hardware accelerator → T4 GPU → Save.

Then run the cell below. If it prints a table with "Tesla T4", you're set. If it errors, the GPU isn't on yet.

```
!nvidia-smi
```

```
Wed Jun 24 16:18:01 2026
```

NVIDIA-SMI 580.82.07				Driver Version: 580.82.07				CUDA Version: 13.0			
GPU	Name			Persistence-M		Bus-Id	Disp.A	Volatile	Uncorr.	ECC	
Fan	Temp	Perf		Pwr:Usage/Cap			Memory-Usage	GPU-Util	Compute M.	MIG M.	
0	Tesla T4			Off		00000000:00:04.0	Off			0	
N/A	41C	P8		11W / 70W		0MiB / 15360MiB		0%	Default	N/A	
Processes:											
GPU	GI	CI		PID	Type	Process name				GPU Memory	
	ID	ID								Usage	
No running processes found											

✓ 1. Install

`ultralytics` is the YOLO library. `roboflow` is just to pull the dataset.

```
!pip install ultralytics roboflow -q
```

```
import ultralytics
ultralytics.checks() # prints versions + confirms the GPU is visible to YOLO
from ultralytics import YOLO
```

```
Ultralytics 8.4.76 Python-3.12.13 torch-2.11.0+cu128 CUDA:0 (Tesla T4, 14913MiB)
Setup complete (2 CPUs, 12.7 GB RAM, 47.3/112.6 GB disk)
```

✓ 2. Get the data

We use a ready-labeled empty-shelf dataset from **Roboflow Universe** so you skip annotation entirely this week. A good candidate:

- `fyp-ormnr/supermarket-empty-shelf-detector` (≈500 images, labels empty / out-of-stock regions)

Other options if that one's down: `empty-space-detection-capstone/out-of-stock-detection`, or browse <https://universe.roboflow.com/browse/retail>

How to get YOUR download snippet (60 seconds)

1. Open the dataset page on Roboflow Universe.
2. Click **Download Dataset** → format **YOLOv11** → **show download code**.
3. It hands you a snippet with *your* API key + the exact workspace/project/version filled in.
4. Paste that over the placeholder cell below.

A free Roboflow account gives you the API key. The snippet looks like the template below — replace the three ALL-CAPS values (or just paste Roboflow's generated version verbatim).

```
# — Replace with the snippet from Roboflow's "show download code" —
# !pip install roboflow

from roboflow import Roboflow
rf = Roboflow(api_key="YOUR_API_KEY")
project = rf.workspace("fyp-ormnr").project("supermarket-empty-shelf-detector")
version = project.version(4)
dataset = version.download("yolov11")

# _____

print("Downloaded to:", dataset.location)
```

```
loading Roboflow workspace...
loading Roboflow project...
Downloading Dataset Version Zip in Supermarket-Empty-Shelf-Detector--4 to yolov11:: 100%|██████████| 45056/45056 [00:
Extracting Dataset Version Zip to Supermarket-Empty-Shelf-Detector--4 in yolov11:: 100%|██████████| 1006/1006 [00:00<
```

✓ Quick fix Roboflow's data.yaml (do this — it saves an annoying error)

Roboflow writes relative paths into `data.yaml` that sometimes break in Colab. This rewrites them to absolute paths so training just works.

```
import yaml, os

base = "/content/Supermarket-Empty-Shelf-Detector--4" # the path from your error
yaml_path = os.path.join(base, "data.yaml")

with open(yaml_path) as f:
    d = yaml.safe_load(f)

def find_images(base, names):
    for n in names:
        p = os.path.join(base, n, "images")
        if os.path.isdir(p):
            return p
    return None

d["train"] = find_images(base, ["train"])
d["val"] = find_images(base, ["valid", "val"]) # Roboflow uses "valid"
test = find_images(base, ["test"])
if test:
    d["test"] = test

with open(yaml_path, "w") as f:
    yaml.safe_dump(d, f)

print("Classes:", d.get("names"))
print("train:", d["train"])
print("val: ", d["val"])
```

```
Classes: ['100- 0-0-S']
train: /content/Supermarket-Empty-Shelf-Detector--4/train/images
val: /content/Supermarket-Empty-Shelf-Detector--4/valid/images
```

✓ 3. Fine-tune YOLO11

`yolo11n` = the nano model: smallest and fastest, perfect for a free T4 and a small dataset. (`yolo11s` / `yolo11m`) are bigger and more accurate but slower — try them later.)

You're not training from scratch — you start from weights pretrained on millions of images and *fine-tune* on shelves. That's why ~50 epochs on a few hundred images is enough to get something real.

Why YOLO11 and not the newer YOLO26? YOLO26 shipped Jan 2026 and is great, but YOLO11 has a year of tutorials, forum answers, and Stack Overflow threads behind it. When you hit an error at 11pm, you want the version everyone else has already debugged. Switching later is literally one word: (`yolo26n.pt`). Learn on the well-worn path.

```
# model = YOLO("/content/drive/MyDrive/shelf_project/best.pt") # pretrained weights -> trained with Robotfl
model = YOLO("yolo11n.pt")
results = model.train(
    data=yaml_path,
    epochs=50,
    imgsz=640,
    batch=16,
    patience=15, # stop early if it plateaus
    name="shelf_v1",
)
```

Epoch	GPU_mem	box_loss	cls_loss	df_l_loss	Instances	Size
42/50	3.05G	1.006	0.7417	0.9563	67	640: 100% 22/22 3.5it/s 6.3s
	Class	Images	Instances	Box(P	R	mAP50 mAP50-95): 100% 4/4 3.4:
	all	97	600	0.88	0.753	0.874 0.59
43/50	3.05G	0.9753	0.7144	0.9538	75	640: 100% 22/22 4.3it/s 5.1s
	Class	Images	Instances	Box(P	R	mAP50 mAP50-95): 100% 4/4 3.2:
	all	97	600	0.877	0.783	0.878 0.597
44/50	3.05G	0.9672	0.7028	0.9491	67	640: 100% 22/22 3.6it/s 6.1s
	Class	Images	Instances	Box(P	R	mAP50 mAP50-95): 100% 4/4 3.1:
	all	97	600	0.851	0.768	0.86 0.573
45/50	3.05G	0.9511	0.6907	0.9335	71	640: 100% 22/22 4.2it/s 5.2s
	Class	Images	Instances	Box(P	R	mAP50 mAP50-95): 100% 4/4 3.4:
	all	97	600	0.919	0.755	0.871 0.598
46/50	3.05G	0.9301	0.6626	0.925	55	640: 100% 22/22 3.6it/s 6.1s
	Class	Images	Instances	Box(P	R	mAP50 mAP50-95): 100% 4/4 4.8:
	all	97	600	0.909	0.78	0.878 0.607
47/50	3.05G	0.9465	0.6639	0.9392	66	640: 100% 22/22 3.4it/s 6.4s
	Class	Images	Instances	Box(P	R	mAP50 mAP50-95): 100% 4/4 1.6:
	all	97	600	0.871	0.802	0.874 0.606
48/50	3.05G	0.9035	0.6504	0.922	69	640: 100% 22/22 3.1it/s 7.1s
	Class	Images	Instances	Box(P	R	mAP50 mAP50-95): 100% 4/4 4.0:
	all	97	600	0.88	0.796	0.875 0.602
49/50	3.05G	0.9025	0.6381	0.9263	70	640: 100% 22/22 3.6it/s 6.1s
	Class	Images	Instances	Box(P	R	mAP50 mAP50-95): 100% 4/4 4.2:
	all	97	600	0.869	0.812	0.881 0.609
50/50	3.05G	0.9107	0.6343	0.923	71	640: 100% 22/22 3.5it/s 6.3s
	Class	Images	Instances	Box(P	R	mAP50 mAP50-95): 100% 4/4 2.4:
	all	97	600	0.878	0.803	0.883 0.615

50 epochs completed in 0.120 hours.

Optimizer stripped from /content/runs/detect/shelf_v1/weights/last.pt, 5.5MB

Optimizer stripped from /content/runs/detect/shelf_v1/weights/best.pt, 5.5MB

Validating /content/runs/detect/shelf_v1/weights/best.pt...

Ultralytics 8.4.76 Python-3.12.13 torch-2.11.0+cu128 CUDA:0 (Tesla T4, 14913MiB)

YOLO11n summary (fused): 101 layers, 2,582,347 parameters, 0 gradients, 6.3 GFLOPs

Class	Images	Instances	Box(P	R	mAP50	mAP50-95): 100%	4/4 1.6:
all	97	600	0.88	0.806	0.884	0.616	

Speed: 0.3ms preprocess, 3.4ms inference, 0.0ms loss, 4.0ms postprocess per image

Results saved to /content/runs/detect/shelf_v1

4. How good is it?

mAP50 is the headline number (mean average precision at IoU 0.5). Don't chase a specific value yet — just read it, eyeball the predictions next, and note it in your writeup. The training run also saved plots (confusion matrix, PR curve) into the run folder.

```
metrics = model.val()
print("mAP50: ", round(metrics.box.map50, 3))
print("mAP50-95: ", round(metrics.box.map, 3))
```

```

Ultralytics 8.4.76 🚀 Python-3.12.13 torch-2.11.0+cu128 CUDA:0 (Tesla T4, 14913MiB)
YOLO11n summary (fused): 101 layers, 2,582,347 parameters, 0 gradients, 6.3 GFLOPs
val: Fast image access ✅ (ping: 0.0±0.0 ms, read: 2527.2±649.9 MB/s, size: 90.0 KB)
val: Scanning /content/Supermarket-Empty-Shelf-Detector--4/valid/labels.cache... 97 images, 0 backgrounds, 0 corrupt:
      Class      Images  Instances   Box(P          R      mAP50  mAP50-95): 100% 7/7 1.6it
        all         97         600      0.88      0.805      0.884      0.615
Speed: 8.6ms preprocess, 8.0ms inference, 0.0ms loss, 4.5ms postprocess per image
Results saved to /content/runs/detect/val
mAP50:      0.884
mAP50-95:  0.615

```

5. Run it on an image

This runs your trained model on validation images and shows the boxes. Later, swap in a photo *you* took at a real store — that's step 7.

```

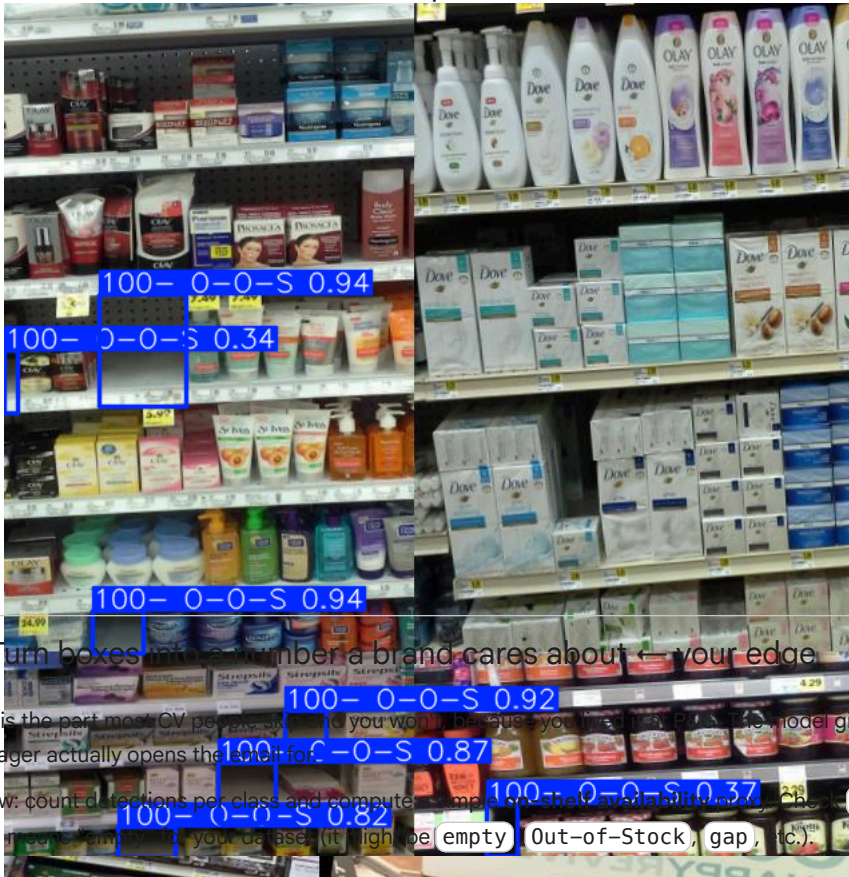
import glob
from PIL import Image
from IPython.display import display

val_images = glob.glob(os.path.join(dataset.location, "valid", "images", "*"))
val_images = val_images or glob.glob(os.path.join(dataset.location, "val", "images", "*"))

preds = model.predict(val_images[:3], save=True, conf=0.25)
for p in preds:
    display(Image.fromarray(p.plot()[..., ::-1])) # BGR->RGB

```


0: 640x640 7 100- 0-0-Ss, 16.8ms
 1: 640x640 11 100- 0-0-Ss, 16.8ms
 2: 640x640 9 100- 0-0-Ss, 16.8ms
 Speed: 1.4ms preprocess, 16.8ms inference, 1.0ms postprocess per image at shape (1, 3, 640, 640)
 Results saved to /content/runs/detect/predict



6. Turn boxes into a number a brand cares about ← your edge

This is the part most CV people miss and you won't be able to do it. The YOLOv3 model gives boxes; you know which metric a brand manager actually opens the shelf for.

Below: count detections per class and compute a sample on shelf availability now. Check `model.names` first and set which class label means empty (it might be empty, Out-of-Stock, gap, etc.).

```
print("Class names in this model:", model.names)

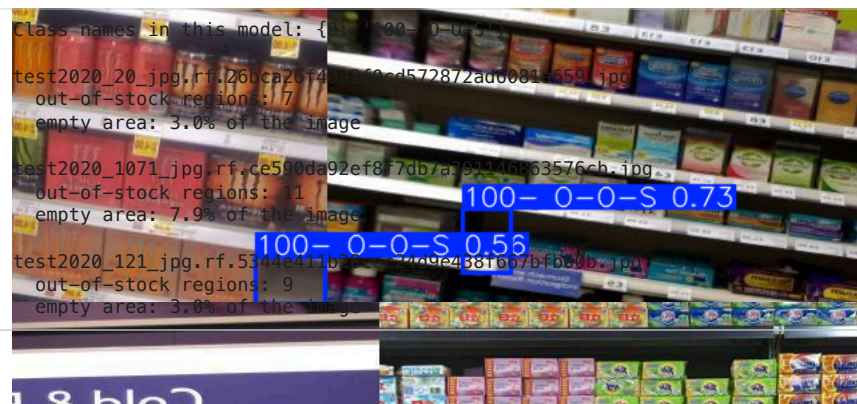
# △ set this to whichever label means an empty/out-of-stock region
EMPTY_LABELS = {"empty", "Empty", "Out-of-Stock", "out-of-stock", "gap", '100- 0-0-S'}

def shelf_report(image_path, conf=0.25):
    r = model.predict(image_path, conf=conf, verbose=False)[0]
    h, w = r.orig_shape          # image size in pixels
    n_gaps = len(r.bboxes)       # number of out-of-stock regions

    gap_area = sum(bw * bh for _, _, bw, bh in r.bboxes.xywh.tolist())
    gap_pct = gap_area / (h * w) * 100

    print(f"\n{os.path.basename(image_path)}")
    print(f"  out-of-stock regions: {n_gaps}")
    print(f"  empty area: {gap_pct:.1f}% of the image")
    return n_gaps, gap_pct

for img in val_images[:3]:
    shelf_report(img)
```



7. Save the model + ship it

Your trained weights are at `runs/detect/shelf_v1/weights/best.pt`. The cell downloads them.

Then `100-0-0-S 0.72` is what makes it a real project, not a tutorial you watched.

1. Take 3-5 photos of an actual shelf at a local store (some full, some with gaps).
2. Run them through `shelf_report()` above.
3. Push to a GitHub repo: the notebook, a few result images, and a short README — what it does, the mAP50, the empty area metric, and one line connecting it to retail out-of-stocks (you know that pitch cold).

That repo is the artifact. It's your first CV project and the first brick of a domain-specific portfolio. Expansion comes after the ugly working version exists — not before.

```
from google.colab import files
```

```
# best.pt is the model. Later run with YOLO("best.pt")
candidates = glob.glob("/content/runs/detect/**/weights/best.pt", recursive=True)
print("Found:", candidates)

latest = max(candidates, key=os.path.getmtime) # the most recent run
print("Downloading:", latest)
files.download(latest)
```

```
Found: ['/content/runs/detect/shelf_v1/weights/best.pt']
Downloading: /content/runs/detect/shelf_v1/weights/best.pt
```

```
import shutil
```

```
# 1. create the Drive folder (this is the part that didn't exist)
os.makedirs("/content/drive/MyDrive/shelf_project", exist_ok=True)

# 2. find the best.pt your training produced
src = max(glob.glob("/content/runs/detect/**/weights/best.pt", recursive=True),
          key=os.path.getmtime)
print("Found weights at:", src)

# 3. copy it into Drive so it survives future sessions
dst = "/content/drive/MyDrive/shelf_project/best.pt"
shutil.copy(src, dst)
print("Saved to:", dst)

# 4. now this works
model = YOLO(dst)
print("Loaded ✓")
```

```
Found weights at: /content/runs/detect/shelf_v1/weights/best.pt
Saved to: /content/drive/MyDrive/shelf_project/best.pt
Loaded ✓
```

8. Try it with my own data!

Pictures taken from the stores already! Let's try it with some fresh data.

1. Make a photo folder in Drive and upload into it
2. Call the `shelf_report` function from step 6 (the single-class version) and run it on every photo
3. See the boxes on my photos

```
# 1. Make a photo folder in Drive and upload into

!pip install pillow-heif -q

from PIL import Image
import pillow_heif

pillow_heif.register_heif_opener()      # teaches PIL to open .HEIC

photo_dir = "/content/drive/MyDrive/shelf_project/photos"
os.makedirs(photo_dir, exist_ok=True)

heic_files = glob.glob("/content/*.HEIC") + glob.glob("/content/*.heic")
print("Found", len(heic_files), "HEIC files")

for path in heic_files:
    img = Image.open(path).convert("RGB")
    name = os.path.splitext(os.path.basename(path))[0] + ".jpg"
    out = os.path.join(photo_dir, name)
    img.save(out, "JPEG", quality=90)
    print("Converted ->", out)
```

Found 0 HEIC files 5.7/5.7 MB 117.3 MB/s eta 0:00:00

2. Call the shelf_report function from step 6 (the single-class version) and run it on every photo

```
for img in glob.glob(f"{photo_dir}/*"):
    shelf_report(img)
```

3. See the boxes on my photos

```
for img in glob.glob(f"{photo_dir}/*"):
    r = model.predict(img, conf=0.25, verbose=False)[0]
    display(Image.fromarray(r.plot()[..., :-1])) # photo with boxes drawn
```

Results: Save it and upload it to Github

```
# 1. Save the annotated photos as files
results_dir = "/content/drive/MyDrive/shelf_project/results"
os.makedirs(results_dir, exist_ok=True)

for img in glob.glob(f"{photo_dir}/*.jpg"):
    r = model.predict(img, conf=0.25, verbose=False)[0]
    out = os.path.join(results_dir, "pred_" + os.path.basename(img))
    Image.fromarray(r.plot()[..., :-1]).save(out)
    print("Saved", out)
```

Train with the photos I take from different stores (71 images)

```
project_2 = rf.workspace("ash-feng").project("empty-shelf-detector-18ba1")
dataset_2 = project_2.version(7).download("yolov11")
```

```
# Load YOUR trained model, not the generic one
model_2 = YOLO("/content/drive/MyDrive/shelf_project/best.pt")
```

```
# Continue training on your 102 photos
results_2 = model_2.train(
    data=f"{dataset_2.location}/data.yaml", # your v3 dataset
    epochs=50,
    imgsz=640, # stop early if no improvement for 15 epochs
    name="finetune_v1.5"
)
```

```
loading Roboflow workspace...
loading Roboflow project...
Exporting format yolov11 in progress : 0.1%
Version export complete for yolov11 format
Downloading Dataset Version Zip in Empty-Shelf-Detector-7 to yolov11:: 100%|██████████| 21826/21826 [00:02<00:00, 71
```



```

Extracting Dataset Version Zip to Empty-Shelf-Detector-7 in yolov11:: 100%|██████████| 493/493 [00:00<00:00, 5094.6i
Ultralytics 8.4.76 Python-3.12.13 torch-2.11.0+cu128 CUDA:0 (Tesla T4, 14913MiB)
engine/trainer: agnostic_nms=False, amp=True, angle=1.0, augment=False, auto_augment=randaugument, batch=16, bgr=0.0,

    from n   params module                                arguments
0         -1 1    464 ultralytics.nn.modules.conv.Conv      [3, 16, 3, 2]
1         -1 1   4672 ultralytics.nn.modules.conv.Conv      [16, 32, 3, 2]
2         -1 1   6640 ultralytics.nn.modules.block.C3k2      [32, 64, 1, False, 0.25]
3         -1 1  36992 ultralytics.nn.modules.conv.Conv      [64, 64, 3, 2]
4         -1 1  26080 ultralytics.nn.modules.block.C3k2      [64, 128, 1, False, 0.25]
5         -1 1 147712 ultralytics.nn.modules.conv.Conv      [128, 128, 3, 2]
6         -1 1  87040 ultralytics.nn.modules.block.C3k2      [128, 128, 1, True]
7         -1 1 295424 ultralytics.nn.modules.conv.Conv      [128, 256, 3, 2]
8         -1 1 346112 ultralytics.nn.modules.block.C3k2      [256, 256, 1, True]
9         -1 1 164608 ultralytics.nn.modules.block.SPPF      [256, 256, 5]
10        -1 1 249728 ultralytics.nn.modules.block.C2PSA      [256, 256, 1]
11        -1 1      0 torch.nn.modules.upsampling.Upsample      [None, 2, 'nearest']
12      [-1, 6] 1      0 ultralytics.nn.modules.conv.Concat      [1]
13        -1 1 111296 ultralytics.nn.modules.block.C3k2      [384, 128, 1, False]
14        -1 1      0 torch.nn.modules.upsampling.Upsample      [None, 2, 'nearest']
15      [-1, 4] 1      0 ultralytics.nn.modules.conv.Concat      [1]
16        -1 1   32096 ultralytics.nn.modules.block.C3k2      [256, 64, 1, False]
17        -1 1  36992 ultralytics.nn.modules.conv.Conv      [64, 64, 3, 2]
18      [-1, 13] 1      0 ultralytics.nn.modules.conv.Concat      [1]
19        -1 1   86720 ultralytics.nn.modules.block.C3k2      [192, 128, 1, False]
20        -1 1 147712 ultralytics.nn.modules.conv.Conv      [128, 128, 3, 2]
21      [-1, 10] 1      0 ultralytics.nn.modules.conv.Concat      [1]
22        -1 1  378880 ultralytics.nn.modules.block.C3k2      [384, 256, 1, True]
23    [16, 19, 22] 1  430867 ultralytics.nn.modules.head.Detect      [1, 16, None, [64, 128, 256]]
YOLO11n summary: 182 layers, 2,590,035 parameters, 2,590,019 gradients, 6.4 GFLOPs

Transferred 499/499 items from pretrained weights
Freezing layer 'model.23.dfl.conv.weight'
AMP: running Automatic Mixed Precision (AMP) checks...
AMP: checks passed ✓
train: Fast image access ✓ (ping: 0.0±0.0 ms, read: 1918.1±861.9 MB/s, size: 85.7 KB)
train: Scanning /content/Empty-Shelf-Detector-7/train/labels... 213 images, 3 backgrounds, 0 corrupt: 100%
train: New cache created: /content/Empty-Shelf-Detector-7/train/labels.cache
albumentations: Blur(p=0.01, blur_limit=(3, 7)), MedianBlur(p=0.01, blur_limit=(3, 7)), ToGray(p=0.01, method='weig
val: Fast image access ✓ (ping: 0.0±0.0 ms, read: 631.8±487.0 MB/s, size: 99.8 KB)
val: Scanning /content/Empty-Shelf-Detector-7/valid/labels... 21 images, 0 backgrounds, 0 corrupt: 100%
val: New cache created: /content/Empty-Shelf-Detector-7/valid/labels.cache
optimizer: 'optimizer=auto' found, ignoring 'lr0=0.01' and 'momentum=0.937' and determining best 'optimizer', 'lr0'
optimizer: AdamW(lr=0.002, momentum=0.9) with parameter groups 81 weight(decay=0.0), 88 weight(decay=0.0005), 87 bi
Plotting labels to /content/runs/detect/finetune_v1.5-6/labels.jpg...
Image sizes 640 train, 640 val
Using 2 dataloader workers
Logging results to /content/runs/detect/finetune_v1.5-6
Starting training for 50 epochs...

```

Epoch	GPU_mem	box_loss	cls_loss	dfl_loss	Instances	Size
-------	---------	----------	----------	----------	-----------	------

```

from ultralytics import YOLO
import glob
m = YOLO("/content/runs/detect/finetune_v1.5-3/weights/best.pt")
m.predict(sorted(glob.glob(f"{dataset_2.location}/valid/images/*.jpg")), save=True, conf=0.4)

```

```

0: 640x640 6 empty shelf gaps, 4.7ms
1: 640x640 4 empty shelf gaps, 4.7ms
2: 640x640 (no detections), 4.7ms
3: 640x640 2 empty shelf gaps, 4.7ms
4: 640x640 3 empty shelf gaps, 4.7ms
5: 640x640 1 empty shelf gap, 4.7ms
6: 640x640 1 empty shelf gap, 4.7ms
7: 640x640 4 empty shelf gaps, 4.7ms
8: 640x640 4 empty shelf gaps, 4.7ms
9: 640x640 (no detections), 4.7ms
10: 640x640 2 empty shelf gaps, 4.7ms
11: 640x640 2 empty shelf gaps, 4.7ms
12: 640x640 6 empty shelf gaps, 4.7ms
13: 640x640 6 empty shelf gaps, 4.7ms
14: 640x640 2 empty shelf gaps, 4.7ms
15: 640x640 4 empty shelf gaps, 4.7ms
16: 640x640 4 empty shelf gaps, 4.7ms
17: 640x640 1 empty shelf gap, 4.7ms
18: 640x640 7 empty shelf gaps, 4.7ms
19: 640x640 (no detections), 4.7ms
20: 640x640 10 empty shelf gaps, 4.7ms
Speed: 2.8ms preprocess, 4.7ms inference, 0.7ms postprocess per image at shape (1, 3, 640, 640)
Results saved to /content/runs/detect/predict-6

```

```
[ultralitics.engine.results.Results object with attributes:
```

```
boxes: ultralytics.engine.results.Boxes object
keypoints: None
masks: None
names: {0: 'empty shelf gap'}
obb: None
orig_img: array([[151, 225, 227],
                 [151, 225, 227],
                 [151, 225, 227],
                 ...,
                 [135, 131, 120],
                 [159, 153, 142],
                 [219, 213, 202]],
                [[151, 225, 227],
                 [151, 225, 227],
                 [151, 225, 227],
                 ...,
                 [174, 170, 159],
                 [181, 175, 164],
                 [211, 205, 194]],
                [[151, 225, 227],
                 [151, 225, 227],
                 [151, 225, 227],
                 ...,
                 [252, 248, 237],
                 [255, 253, 242],
                 [255, 255, 247]],
                ...,
```

```
import IPython.display as ipd, glob, os
latest = sorted(glob.glob("/content/runs/detect/predict*"), key=os.path.getmtime)[-1]
for p in sorted(glob.glob(f"{latest}/*.jpg"))[:-1]:
    print(os.path.basename(p)); ipd.display(ipd.Image(filename=p))
```